

Council Meeting
June 19, 2019
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The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, June 19, 2019, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Lovett at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present were:

At-Large Councilor Claire Lessard
Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Stone
Assistant Mayor Allen Damren
Mayor Charlene Lovett
At-Large Councilor Abigail Kier
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Ward II Councilor Scott Pope

Also present:

John MacLean, Interim City Manager
Mary Walter, Finance Director

AGENDA CHANGES

None

MAYOR’S NOTES

- Monday, 1 p.m. attended Executive Finance Committee meeting for County Delegation. Next week they will approve the County budget. There is a proposed budget increase. Not all agreed with it. They will deliberate further.
- The legislature will vote on the state budget. The budget contains money for infrastructure improvements for Claremont. The proposed state budget increase is 8.25%; all believe that is too high. They will deliberate further on what the recommended increase should be.

CITY MANAGER’S REPORT

None

CITIZEN’S FORUM

No one spoke.

OLD BUSINESS

City Manager Search Update

Mr. Damren said the City Manager Search Committee has interviewed seven applicants, so far. They will interview three more tomorrow. Then they will determine which applicants to bring to the Council. He suggested Councilors may interview the applicants the second or third week in July. The City may need to pay travel and lodging expenses for certain candidates.

NEW BUSINESS

Resolution 2020-2 Adopt the 2020 General Fund Budget – Public Hearing

WHEREAS in accordance with the Charter of the City of Claremont, and the Statutes of the State of New Hampshire, the City Council is required to establish a budget for its appropriations and revenues for its municipal activities; and

WHEREAS in accordance with said Charter, a public hearing was held on June 19, 2019;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, that it adopts the following for its proposed expenditures and revenues for all departments for its 2020 fiscal year as follows. *(Majority Vote Required)*

2020 GENERAL FUND

Expenditure Summary:

Policy and Administration

Policy	\$ 644,897
City Administration	876,517
Elections & Registrations	13,683
Assessing	355,485
Municipal Complex	398,158
Planning & Development	916,355
General Services	1,012,029

Public Safety

Communications – 911	\$ 539,891
Police Department	2,902,537
Fire Department	2,416,317

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Health & Welfare

Welfare Department	\$ 369,765
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Public Works

Sanitation	\$ 192,219
Streets & Roads	2,959,495

Library	394,322
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Debt Service	\$ 1,170,476
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Public Service Enterprises

Cemetery	\$ 188,761
Airport	112,954

Recreation & Parks

Parks	\$ 402,503
CSB-Recreation	1,105,954

Outside Agency	\$ 25,000
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TOTAL	\$16,997,318
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Revenue Summary:

Taxes	\$ 17,050
Interest on Taxes	375,000
State of New Hampshire	1,057,500
Licenses/Permits/Fees	2,199,420
Departmental Revenue	1,093,637
Rent of City Property	72,616
Payments in Lieu of Taxes	98,683
Miscellaneous Revenue	123,220
From Fund Balance	342,590
From Capital Reserve	73,500
Used to Reduce Tax Rate	500,000

REVENUE TOTAL	\$ 5,953,216
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A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Mr. Pope to adopt Resolution 2020-2 Adopt the 2020 General Fund Budget

Mr. Damren read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett gave a quick overview of what this budget does for the City including \$500,000 from Fund Balance to help reduce the tax rate. The City is not proposing an increase to the tax rate. We expect an increase in both the County and school tax rates. She cautioned about adding too much to this budget.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Kier to add \$27,294 to the CSB-Recreation budget.

There was a discussion about adding the part-time maintenance position. Mark Brislin, Parks and Recreation Director, said the building is six years old and maintenance is needed. The cleaners come in at night. They only clean, no fixing. This position will help supplement the cleaning and will help with fixing broken items such as door handles.

Voice vote: motion carried 6-2 with Messrs. O'Hearne and Stone voting no.

There was a discussion about adding \$500 to the cemetery building facility M&R line to help reduce heat loss and \$1,000 for maintenance of the cemetery backhoe.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Koloski to add \$500 to Cemetery building facility M&R, line item 510.

Voice vote: motion carried 5-3 with Mr. Stone, Mr. Damren and Mayor Lovett voting no.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Koloski to add \$1,000 to Cemetery vehicle equipment maintenance, line 530.

Voice vote: motion failed 2-6 with Mr. O'Hearne, Mr. Stone, Mr. Damren, Mr. Koloski, Mr. Pope and Mayor Lovett voting no.

Mayor Lovett said Southwestern Community Services had requested additional money for the bus service.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Damren to add \$5,000 to Outside Agency request for Southwestern Community Services line item 160.

Ms. Walter said unless she is told differently, this would come from Fund Balance as is the rest of the money in that line item.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Koloski to add \$3,000 to Streets & Roads for signs and street markers, line item 580.

There was a discussion about adding money into the budget to install flashing signs at one or more crosswalks.

Victor St. Pierre, Public Works Director, said the cost is about \$5,600 each. There is money in the budget (under sidewalks) to put one outside City Hall.

He said there was a recent safety program put on by the state and they thought Claremont's crosswalks in the downtown were in the correct locations. If there is enough money placed in the budget for a second signal, he would like to look at putting it on Broad Street, where the high school kids cross to Monadnock Park.

Voice vote: motion failed 3-5 with Messrs. Koloski, Pope, Stone, O'Hearne, and Mayor Lovett voting no.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mayor Lovett to add \$5,000 to Streets & Roads for sidewalks, line item 570.

There was more discussion about putting in a second signal and that by buying two, there would be a cost savings of about \$600.

Voice vote: motion carried 5-3 with Messrs. O'Hearne, Stone and Koloski voting no.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Koloski to add \$7,240 to Streets & Roads for building and facilities maintenance, line item 510.

Mr. St. Pierre said the building is a block building, built in 1945, and you can see through some of the blocks. There would be a cost savings in heat of about 30-40% through the outside walls. The roof repair is not in this budget.

Roll call vote: motion failed 2-6 with Messrs. O'Hearne, Stone, Damren, Koloski, Pope, and Mayor Lovett voting no.

There was a discussion about hydrant rentals.

Mr. MacLean said a study had been done years ago and we may need a tune-up. Even if the Council passes the budget, they can come back to request to amend it, if needed.

Councilors suggested it might be a good time to do an analysis to determine what a fair amount would be for hydrant rentals and that this should go to the Policy Committee.

There was a discussion about the Fire Department's proposal to dispose of engine 2 and its effects on Claremont's ISO rating.

Mr. MacLean said the City is three years away from having to do another ISO analysis. He suggested the City do its own analysis to determine when would be a good time to let that equipment go.

There was a consensus that Councilors didn't think they want to let go of engine 2.

Fire Chief Bryan Burr recommends holding off on any study until they are ready for the five-year study. We currently have a .45 credit out of .5. He proposed in the next few years to make changes on the water side, etc., and then do the study. Also, training could be improved. He suggested to improve on those two points and see where we are at the next study.

There was a consensus of the Council to leave this as proposed in the budget.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

A motion was made by Mr. Damren and seconded by Ms. Kier to amend the main motion for the General Fund Expenses Budget; the amount being \$17,037,612, and Revenue \$5,956,216.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Voice vote to adopt Resolution 2020-2 Adopt the 2020 General Fund Budget as amended above: motion carried 8-0.

Resolution 2020-3 Adopt the 2020 Water Division Budget – Public Hearing

WHEREAS in accordance with the Charter of the City of Claremont and the Statutes of the State of New Hampshire, the City Council is required to establish a budget for its appropriations and revenues for its municipal activities; and

WHEREAS in accordance with said Charter, a public hearing was held on June 19, 2019 to provide oral and written comments on said proposed appropriations and revenues; and

WHEREAS the City of Claremont Water and Sewer Divisions are operated as separate entities and by revenues derived from their individual enterprises;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, that it hereby adopts the following for its proposed expenditures and revenues for the Water Division as follows. *(Majority Vote Required)*

2020 PROPOSED WATER DIVISION BUDGET

REVENUE

Water Revenue	\$1,913,723
Miscellaneous Revenue	18,000
From Retained Earnings/Fund Balance	0
TOTAL	\$1,931,723
 EXPENSE	
Water Department	\$1,931,723
TOTAL	\$1,931,723

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Resolution 2020-3 Adopt the 2020 Water Division Budget.

Ms. Kier read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Resolution 2020 – 4 Adopt the 2020 Sewer Division Budget – Public Hearing

WHEREAS in accordance with the Charter of the City of Claremont and the Statutes of the State of New Hampshire, the City Council is required to establish a budget for its appropriations and revenues for its municipal activities; and

WHEREAS in accordance with said Charter, a public hearing was held on June 19, 2019 to provide oral and written comments on said proposed appropriations and revenues; and

WHEREAS the City of Claremont Water and Sewer Divisions are operated as separate entities and by revenues derived from their individual enterprises;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, that it hereby adopts the following for its proposed expenditures and revenues for the Sewer Division as follows. *(Majority Vote Required)*

2020 PROPOSED SEWER DIVISION BUDGET

REVENUE

Sewer Revenue	\$2,426,517
Miscellaneous Revenue	308,976
From Retained Earnings/Fund Balance	124,061

TOTAL	\$2,859,554
EXPENSE	
Sewer Department	\$2,859,554
TOTAL	\$2,859,554

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Damren to adopt Resolution 2020-4 Adopt the 2020 Sewer Division Budget.

Ms. Kier read the resolution into the record.

Ms. Walter said during the budget process that she had stated that the City had to pay SRF loan payment 18. Council can amend the budget now or come back to do a supplemental appropriation of \$187,192 later. It will come from Sewer Department retained earnings.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Damren to amend the motion to adopt Resolution 2020-4 Adopt the 2020 Sewer Division Budget by adding \$187,192 to Revenue for total of \$3,046,746, and to add \$187,192 to the Expense budget for a total of \$3,046,746.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Voice vote to adopt Resolution 2020-4 Adopt the 2020 Sewer Division Budget as amended: motion carried 8-0.

Resolution 2020-5 Adopt the 2020 Downtown Tax Increment Finance District Budget – Public Hearing

WHEREAS in accordance with the Charter of the City of Claremont and the Statutes of the State of New Hampshire, the City Council is required to establish a budget for its appropriations and revenues for its municipal activities; and

WHEREAS in accordance with said Charter, a public hearing was held on June 19, 2019 to provide oral and written comments on said proposed appropriations and revenues; and

WHEREAS in accordance with RSA 162-K:12 the City Council must review and approve the operating budget of a tax increment finance district;

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, that it hereby adopts the following for its proposed expenditures and revenues for the Downtown Tax Increment Finance District. *(Majority Vote Required)*

**2020 PROPOSED TAX INCREMENT FINANCE
DISTRICT BUDGET – DOWNTOWN**

REVENUE

Revenues	\$783,600
TOTAL	\$783,600

EXPENSE

Expenses	\$783,600
TOTAL	\$783,600

Mayor Lovett said based on changes that have already been made, the Revenues, Expenses, and Total should read \$781,600.

A motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Stone to suspend Council Rules as Resolution 2020-5 was not in the Council packet.

Roll call vote:

Lessard - yes

O’Hearne - yes

Stone - yes

Damren - yes

Kier - yes

Koloski - yes

Pope - yes

Lovett - yes

Motion carried 8-0.

A motion was made by Mr. Pope and seconded by Ms. Kier to adopt Resolution 2020-5 Adopt the 2020 Downtown Tax Increment Finance District Budget.

Mr. Pope read the resolution into the record, changing the Revenues, Expenses, and Total amounts to \$781,600.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Resolution 2019 – 25 Encumbrances – Public Hearing

BE IT RESOLVED by the Council of the City of Claremont, New Hampshire, after public hearing duly noticed, that it hereby adopts the following for the 2019 encumbrances: *(Majority vote required)*

Dept #	Department - General Description	Amount	Detailed Description
416	Planning & Development	\$ 3,000	Re-Encumber for the replacement of dead trees in the city center (is on hold awaiting decision on larger Pleasant St. Revitalization project).
421	Police	\$ 24,930	Re-Encumber for the Remodel and upgrades to booking room and cell area. Done minimal work as of year-end.
421	Police - Re-encumber from FY2018 & FY 19- recruiting bonus	\$ 30,000	Re-Encumber Recruiting Bonus: Spent \$17,200 in FY 18 for 3 hires and none in FY19. Would like to continue carrying over funds in hopes of attracting qualified candidates.
441	Streets & Road - City Culverts	\$ 19,742	Re-Encumber for Bible Hill delays/overruns
415	Maintenance	\$ 111,742	Encumber 2019 funds for flat roof repairs
415	Maintenance	\$ 17,000	Encumber to Replace flooring in Council Chambers, hallway and 3 entryways, bids being evaluated now
416	Planning & Development	\$ 12,000	Recent Amendments in the final design of East St. increased costs.
481	Parks & Recreation	\$ 500	Applying for a grant and this would be our 20% match.
TIFD	Parking Garage	\$ 18,000	RFQ proposal done and currently the contract is being negotiated but is not completed yet.
Total Request to Encumber into FY 2019		\$ 236,914	To use the General Fund monies already raised on the tax rate for projects that were not able to be completed in the current Fiscal year.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Ms. Kier to adopt Resolution 2019-25 Encumbrances.

Mr. Koloski read the resolution into the record.

Mayor Lovett opened the public hearing. No one spoke. She closed it.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Mayor Lovett said that the vacant Council seat needs to be filled by July 10. She suggested accepting applications through June 28.

Mr. O'Hearne pointed out that according to Roberts Rules, the Council has to formally accept Jeremy Zullo's resignation, which it did not do at the last Council meeting.

There was a brief discussion about whether or not Roberts Rules applied to this Council.

A motion was made by Mr. Koloski and seconded by Ms. Kier to accept Jeremy Zullo's resignation.

Voice vote: 8-0.

Councilors agreed to interview candidates at the beginning of the July 10th meeting, right after Roll Call.

Mayor Lovett said according to NHMA that due to the Council's body size, the Council doesn't have to follow Roberts Rules and that the Council Rules will have to be updated to reflect that fact.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None

ADJOURNMENT

At 8:44 p.m., a motion was made by Ms. Kier and seconded by Mr. Damren to adjourn.

Voice vote: motion carried 8-0.

Respectfully Submitted,

Dorée M. Russell
Clerk to the Council